

"Khelo India is an inclusive platform... the rise of sports talent in the country exhibits its soft power... Sports are multifarious in terms of self-employment, education, health, and other opportunities."

— **Shri Narendra Modi,** Hon'ble Prime Minister of India



CHIEF MINISTER

NITISH KUMAR'S LEADERSHIP SHINES IN KHELO INDIA YOUTH GAMES 2025

In a remarkable moment that has elevated Bihar's position on India's sporting map, the 7th edition of the Khelo India Youth Games (KIYG) was successfully hosted in the state in May 2025. The event marked a significant achievement not just in terms of sports participation and infrastructure development, but also in terms of the transformative leadership of Bihar's Chief Minister, Nitish Kumar. Under his direct supervision and persistent vision, Bihar emerged not only as a host but as a bold claimant to future leadership in India's evolving sporting ecosystem.

Grand Inauguration

The opening ceremony of KIYG 2025 set a grand precedent for the rest of the event. Held at the Patliputra Sports Complex in Patna, the inauguration featured a special video address by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who acknowledged Bihar's rapid transformation into a sporting hub and praised the efforts taken by the state government. The Prime Minister's words echoed the aspirations of thousands of young athletes and were a testament to the immense organizational strides taken under Chief Minister Nitish Kumar's guidance. Nitish Kumar, present at the venue, called the moment a proud milestone for the people of Bihar and an opportunity to present the new, confident face of the state.

28 Sports, 5 Districts, 6000 atheletes

The magnitude of the event was unprecedented in Bihar's history. Spanning 12 days, the Khelo India Youth Games 2025 brought together over 6000 athletes from across 36 states and union territories. These participants competed across 28 disciplines ranging from athletics, boxing, and wrestling to indigenous sports like kho-kho, kabaddi, and thang-ta. The Games were spread across five cities—Patna, Rajgir, Gaya, Bhagalpur, and Begusarai—each hosting multiple disciplines and welcoming waves of enthusiastic participants, officials, and spectators. Hosting an event of this scale demanded enormous logistical